property, it seems, has been sacrificed without due notice, and in a very harsh manner. In one case even a poor woman in the agonies of childbirth was denied one night's delay. We would fain hope that these accounts are grossly exaggerated. The worst feature of the case, as represented, is that no record is kept of the injury to individuals, so that it will be difficult for them to obtain compensation. [34]

Howrah Terminus on the Land of Captain Oakes

The railway company at Calcutta has advertised for tenders for the construction of the section of the line which extends from Pandua to Raneegunge, to commence with the approaching cold weather: for the convenience of contractors, the section was to be divided into lots of between five and six miles each. *The Hurkaru* mentions that the site of the railway terminus at Howrah has been fixed upon. The property belonging to Captain Oakes, near the Howrah Ghaut, is the place selected. [35]

Landlord Holds Up Railway Works

The railway has, it appears, been brought to a stand for the present from the opposition offered by a wealthy landholder (Goopee Kistna Gossain, of Serampore) to the invasion of his grounds without legal authority. Great blame attaches somewhere for the delay which has occurred in providing such authority. A commissioner has been appointed for obtaining and making over the land required, but he cannot interfere till empowered by a legislative enactment, and the necessary Act, which ought to have been Law months since, and was some time ago promulgated in draft, has not yet been passed. There have been great complaints of the harsh and summary proceedings of the 'railway pioneers' to the poor people along the line, who found their houses pulled down about their ears without a moment's notice. [36]

Work Paces Ahead

The *Friend of India* announces, with the most unfeigned satisfaction, that the first inch of the ground was made over to the railway establishment on the 25th of January, 'one year, two months, and eleven days after the despatch of the letter from the Court of Directors, in which they twice enforced the necessity of accelerating this preliminary measure'.

The *Morning Chronicle* states that at Balikal at least nine hundred coolies were busily at work every day at the railway embankments, which were rapidly rising. The *Roshoshagar* , a native paper, indicates some of the peculiar difficulties which these works will encounter in India.

On account of the famous Musjeed of the Pandooah falling within the boundary of the railway line, a show of resistance and violence had been offered by the good Mussulmans of the place towards the railway people when they expressed a desire of levelling it to the ground, adding that the British government must first extirpate them before they break down their place of worship. The magistrate of Hooghly, with a company of native infantry, went to the spot, and the whole hubbub was soon at an end. [3 7]

BOMBAY: THE BEGINNINGS